

Single Supplier vs. Multiple Suppliers

There are pros and cons on both sides of the discussion of single supplier vs. multiple suppliers.

The benefits of a single supplier are:

- potentially lower costs,
- easier deployment (by using dedicated supplier-created components), and
- ease of management (through the use of supplier-provided tools).

The cons of the single supplier model include:

- data lock-in (where providers charge users to release or transfer their own data);
- also design lock-in (where the use of dedicated supplier-provided components means that applications would need to be redesigned/ reconfigured to be deployed on any other platform).
- Finally, single supplier faults (where one or more data centres owned by a supplier suffer a fault or loss of service) or a common vulnerability is introduced across multiple centres of a single supplier, is a major risk consideration when dealing with single suppliers.

Many larger companies/ enterprises decide to minimise their risk by using a multi-supplier model.

The cons of this approach are:

- that the designs need to be more complex (as they cant use any proprietary 'shortcuts'),
- they may be more expensive, and



- it may be harder to find tools that support multi-supplier deployments.

The main advantage of the multi-supplier model is that it is more resilient (in that a single supplier fault will not jeopardise the whole solution) - making DR safer and more reliable.